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Service Catalogue

Single source of truth

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Learning Objectives

- understand the basics of service catalogues
- being able to create own service catalogues

Definition

- “An IT service catalog is the single source of accurate information on all IT services offered by an organization’s IT department.”[me]
- Aka **Single source of truth**
- Information about services that can be used by customers and employees
- Collect and store all information about the services
 - ▶ Organizational
 - ▶ Technical

Motivation

- Provide a common frame of reference and understanding of offered service (users and employees), e.g.
- Overview of provided services available
- Fast access to the information about a service, e.g. useful in case of failure
- Required by ITIL and ISO20000
- Avoid noise, e.g. in communication (mail, chat):
 - ▶ Who is responsible for this service?
 - ▶ Do we have this service?
 - ▶ Which version are we running on?

Contents of a Service Catalogue

- Depends on the institute/company
- contents e.g.:
 - ▶ Service-name, ID
 - ▶ Responsible, owner,
 - ▶ Service contact
 - ▶ Availability
 - ▶ Dependencies to other services
 - ▶ Maintenance times
 - ▶ Pricing
- Some content is mandatory in specific contexts, e.g. ISO20000
- Some information is just for employees and should not be available to customers

Technologies, tools and formats to store service catalogue

■ Usually freedom of choice, e.g.:

- ▶ Special tools and application for service management
- ▶ Databases and according schemas
- ▶ Wikis
- ▶ Textfiles (JSON, YAML etc.) in a VCS (git, subversion)

■ Requirements:

- ▶ Fast and easy access
- ▶ Easy maintenance of entries (updates etc.)
- ▶ Reliable, high availability
- ▶ Clear processes/responsibilities (how to update, who etc.)

■ Requirements by certifications, e.g. ITIL or ISO2000, may reduce the options

Example: Service Catalogue in GWDG

- GWDG is transitioning to a hybrid approach
- Information gathering and maintenance in JSON + git
- Changes etc. are trackable
- Providing small editor to generate the JSON
- Database is populated using scripts processing the JSON files

DEMO: editor

Exercise

■ Exercise 1+2

References

- [mme] <https://www.manageengine.com/products/service-desk/itil/what-is-service-catalog.html#what-is-service-catalog>
- [sl] Simplilearn
- [it] Itil training